15 Frontend Development with Starter Kits

Laravel 12 brings a fresh and simplified approach to full-stack development by integrating popular frontend stacks directly into the project scaffolding process. Using the new Laravel Installer CLI, developers can now select a frontend starter kit interactively at the time of project creation. This seamless integration allows for quick setup of modern frontend technologies—**React**, **Vue.js**, or **Livewire**—without needing to install them manually after project creation.

In this chapter, you will explore how Laravel 12 supports modern frontend development through starter kits. You will learn how to initialize a Laravel project using the Laravel CLI, choose and configure a frontend stack, and build simple interactive components using React, Vue.js, or Livewire. You will also compare the features and use cases of each frontend option to help guide your selection for real-world applications.

15.1 Introduction to Laravel Frontend Scaffolding

Frontend development in Laravel 12 has been streamlined with the improved **Laravel Installer CLI**. Instead of manually installing Breeze or Jetstream via Composer, developers can now choose a frontend stack during the project creation process. Laravel 12 supports three official starter kits: **React**, **Vue.js**, and **Livewire**. These kits are powered by Breeze or Jetstream behind the scenes but are presented through a user-friendly selection menu when running `laravel new`.

This new approach makes Laravel even more approachable for both new and experienced developers by minimizing configuration overhead and enabling a quick start with a full-stack environment.

15.2 React Starter Kit

React is a declarative, component-based JavaScript library used to build dynamic user interfaces. Laravel 12 allows developers to scaffold a new Laravel + React project right from the beginning using the Laravel CLI.